BONUS · NEUROKIDS

Daily Mindfulness for Kids

Simple exercises to help your child find calm, focus, and emotional balance every day

NeuroKids™

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What Is Mindfulness?

*Mindfulness means paying attention to what is happening **right now** — what you see, hear, feel, and think — without judging any of it as good or bad. It is like giving your brain a quiet moment to rest and notice the world around you.*

Why Does Mindfulness Help Kids?

When you practice mindfulness, amazing things happen inside your brain and body:

Calmer Feelings

Mindfulness slows down your breathing and heart rate. This sends a message to your brain that says, "Everything is okay."

Better Focus

Practicing mindfulness is like exercising a muscle in your brain. The more you practice, the easier it becomes to pay attention at school and at home.

Handling Big Emotions

Mindfulness helps you notice feelings before they get too big. You can choose how to respond instead of just reacting.

Better Sleep

Calming your mind before bed helps you fall asleep faster and sleep more deeply, so you wake up feeling rested and ready.

How to Use This Book

You do not need to do everything at once. Pick one or two activities each day. Try the **Morning Mindfulness** exercises when you wake up, the **Calm-Down Techniques** when you feel upset, the **Mindful Activities** any time you want to have fun and focus, and the **Bedtime Wind-Down** before sleep. There is no wrong way to practice — just start!

1

Morning Mindfulness

Start your day feeling calm, grateful, and ready for anything.

Belly Breathing Tracker

How to do belly breathing:

1. Sit or lie down comfortably. Place one hand on your chest and the other on your belly.
2. Breathe in slowly through your nose for 4 counts. Feel your belly push your hand up like a balloon filling with air.
3. Hold your breath gently for 2 counts.
4. Breathe out slowly through your mouth for 6 counts. Feel your belly go back down.
5. Repeat 5 times. That is one session!

Color or check one circle each day you practice:

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5	Day 6	Day 7
Day 8	Day 9	Day 10	Day 11	Day 12	Day 13	Day 14
Day 15	Day 16	Day 17	Day 18	Day 19	Day 20	Day 21

> **Tip**
>
> Try belly breathing right when you wake up, before you even get out of bed. Three weeks of daily practice builds a lasting habit!

Body Scan Checklist

A body scan helps you notice how each part of your body feels. Lie down, close your eyes, and slowly move your attention from your toes to the top of your head. For each body part, ask: *"How does this feel right now?"*

BODY PART	CHECK	HOW DOES IT FEEL?
Toes & Feet	☐	
Legs & Knees	☐	
Belly & Hips	☐	
Chest & Back	☐	
Hands & Arms	☐	
Shoulders & Neck	☐	
Face & Jaw	☐	
Top of Head	☐	

> **Remember**
>
> There are no wrong answers. You might feel warm, tingly, tight, heavy, light, or nothing at all. Just notice it and move on to the next part. If you find a spot that feels tense, breathe into it and imagine the tension melting away like ice cream in the sun.

Gratitude Morning Page

Every morning, write down **3 things** you are grateful for. They can be big or small — a warm bed, your pet, a fun game, a friend who made you laugh. Gratitude helps your brain focus on the good things in your life!

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

> **Challenge**
> Try not to repeat the same thing twice in one week. This trains your brain to notice new good things every day!

Mindful Eating Card

Pick one snack (a raisin, a piece of fruit, a cracker, or a small piece of chocolate). Instead of eating it quickly, use all five senses to explore it. This exercise takes about 5 minutes.

1. **Look** — Hold the food in your hand. What color is it? What shape? Are there any lines, spots, or shiny parts? Describe what you see on the line below.

2. **Touch** — Close your eyes and feel the food between your fingers. Is it smooth, bumpy, sticky, soft, or hard?

3. **Smell** — Bring it close to your nose. Breathe in slowly. What do you smell? Sweet, sour, earthy, or nothing at all?

4. **Listen** — Place the food near your ear and squeeze it gently, or break it. Does it make a sound? Snap? Crinkle? Silence?

5. **Taste** — Put the food on your tongue but do not chew yet. What do you notice? Now chew very slowly. How does the flavor change? Where in your mouth do you feel it?

6. **Reflect** — How was this different from the way you usually eat? What surprised you?

Positive Affirmation Cards

Cut out these cards and keep them in a jar, on your mirror, or in your backpack. Pick one every morning, read it out loud, and repeat it three times. Say it like you really mean it!

✂----------

I am brave, even when things feel hard.	My mistakes help me learn and grow.
I am kind to myself and to others.	I can do difficult things, one step at a time.
My feelings matter, and it is okay to feel them.	I am loved just the way I am.
Today is full of good possibilities.	I choose to focus on what I can control.

✂----------

Make Your Own!

Write two affirmations that are special to you:

2

Calm-Down Techniques

Tools you can use anytime you feel worried, angry, or overwhelmed.

5-4-3-2-1 Senses Worksheet

When big feelings start to take over, this exercise brings you back to the present moment. Look around you right now and fill in each box.

5 THINGS I CAN SEE

4 THINGS I CAN HEAR

3 THINGS I CAN TOUCH

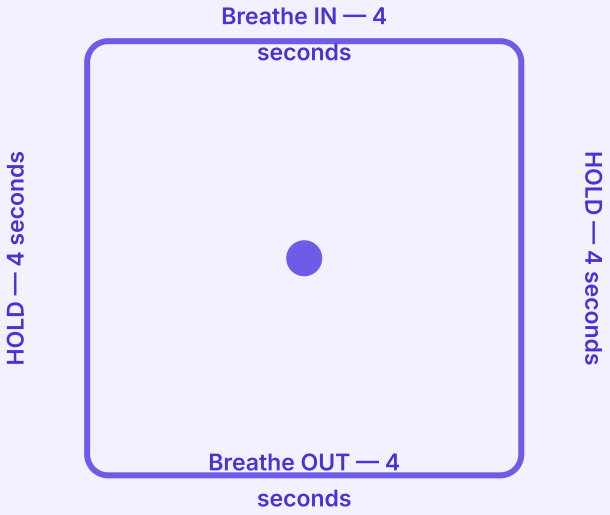
2 THINGS I CAN SMELL

1 THING I CAN TASTE

> **When to Use This**
>
> This works great before a test, after an argument, or any time your heart is racing and your thoughts feel jumbled. You can even do it silently in your head without writing!

Breathing Square

Trace your finger slowly along each side of the square while you breathe. This technique is also called “box breathing” and is used by astronauts, athletes, and even firefighters to stay calm under pressure.



1. Start at the top-left corner. Breathe **in** slowly through your nose as you trace along the top for 4 seconds.
2. Trace down the right side while you **hold** your breath for 4 seconds.
3. Trace along the bottom while you breathe **out** slowly through your mouth for 4 seconds.
4. Trace up the left side while you **hold** again for 4 seconds.
5. Repeat 4 rounds. Notice how your body feels after each round.

HOW DO I FEEL AFTER 4 ROUNDS?

Calm Jar Instructions

A calm jar (sometimes called a “mind jar”) is a bottle full of water and glitter. When you shake it, the swirling glitter looks like your busy thoughts. As the glitter settles, your mind settles too. Make one with a grown-up!

What You Need:

- [ ] A clear jar or plastic bottle with a tight lid
- [ ] Warm water (not boiling)
- [ ] Clear glue or glitter glue (about 2 tablespoons)
- [ ] Fine glitter (any colors you like)
- [ ] A drop of food coloring (optional)
- [ ] Strong tape or hot glue to seal the lid

Steps:

1. Fill the jar about three-quarters full with warm water.
2. Add the clear glue or glitter glue. Stir gently until it dissolves.
3. Add 2–3 teaspoons of fine glitter. More glue = slower settling. More water = faster settling.
4. Add one drop of food coloring if you want a tint.
5. Fill the rest of the jar with water, leaving a small air bubble at the top.
6. Ask a grown-up to seal the lid tightly with strong tape or hot glue so it does not leak.
7. Shake it up and watch! Take slow breaths as the glitter settles.

> **How to Use Your Calm Jar**
>
> When you feel upset, shake the jar and then sit still. Watch the glitter swirl and slowly fall. Try matching your breathing to the glitter — breathe in as it swirls, breathe out as it sinks. By the time the glitter reaches the bottom, your mind will feel calmer too.

Progressive Muscle Relaxation

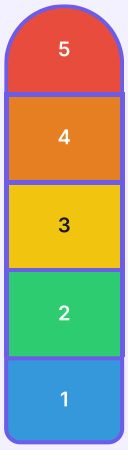
This exercise teaches your muscles the difference between tense and relaxed. Squeeze each body part tight for **5 seconds**, then release and let it go floppy like a cooked noodle. A grown-up can read this aloud to you.

BODY PART	HOW TO TENSE	DONE?	FEELING
Hands	Make tight fists, squeeze as hard as you can	☐	
Arms	Bend your arms and flex your muscles like a strongman	☐	
Shoulders	Shrug your shoulders up to your ears as high as possible	☐	
Face	Scrunch your whole face: squeeze eyes, wrinkle nose, press lips	☐	
Belly	Tighten your tummy like someone is about to tickle you	☐	
Legs	Straighten your legs and push your toes forward, squeeze tight	☐	
Feet	Curl your toes tightly like you are gripping the floor	☐	
Whole Body	Tense everything at once — hands, arms, face, belly, legs, feet!	☐	

> **After You Finish**
>
> Lie still for one minute. Notice how your whole body feels. Many kids say they feel “warm,” “heavy,” or “melted.” That is your body in relaxation mode!

Emotion Thermometer

Your feelings have different levels, just like temperature. This thermometer helps you figure out *how big* your feeling is right now. Point to the level that matches, then choose a coping strategy that fits.



Exploding — I cannot think clearly

Very Upset — I need help now

Getting Upset — I need a tool

A Little Off — I notice something

Calm — I am doing great

My Coping Strategies for Each Level:

LEVEL	SUGGESTED STRATEGY	MY PERSONAL STRATEGY
1	Keep going — enjoy the calm!	
2	Take 3 deep breaths	
3	Use the Breathing Square or 5-4-3-2-1	
4	Walk away, use the calm jar, talk to someone	
5	Find a safe quiet spot, ask a grown-up for help	

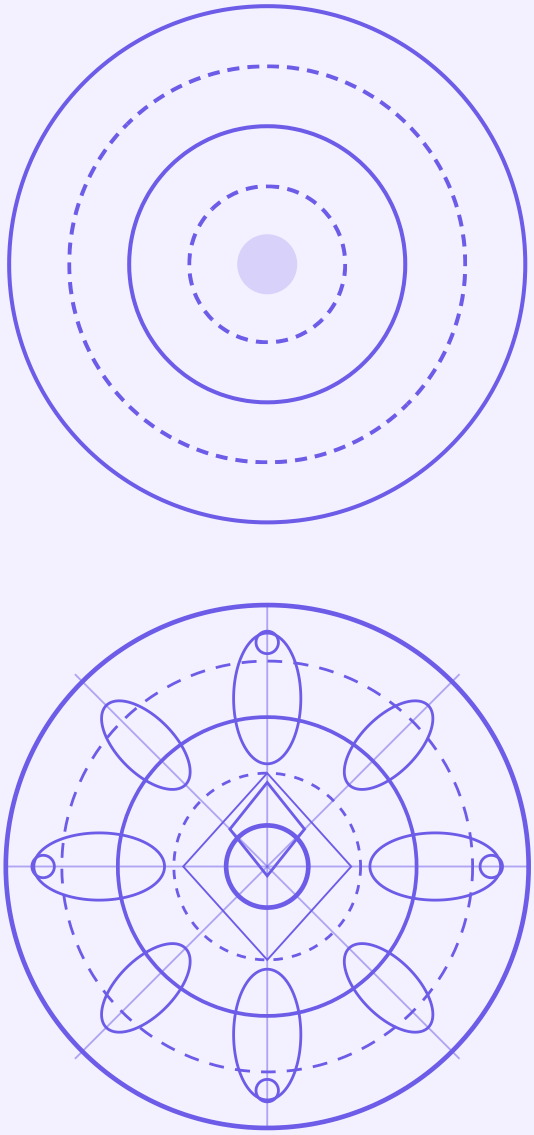
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Mindful Activities

Fun exercises that build focus, gratitude, and kindness every day.

Mindful Coloring Page

Color the pattern below slowly and carefully. Focus on staying inside the lines. Notice the feeling of the pencil or crayon on the paper. If your mind wanders, gently bring it back to the colors and shapes. There is no rush and no “right” way to color it.



Use colored pencils, crayons, or markers. Take your time and breathe slowly as you color.

Nature Observation Journal

Go outside (a garden, a park, or even a window will work). Spend 5 minutes just noticing. Then fill in this page. Being in nature is one of the best ways to practice mindfulness!

DATE & PLACE

WHAT I CAN SEE (DESCRIBE 3 THINGS IN DETAIL)

WHAT I CAN HEAR (LIST EVERY SOUND, EVEN QUIET ONES)

WHAT I CAN SMELL

WHAT I CAN FEEL (THE WIND? WARM SUN? COLD AIR? GRASS UNDER MY FEET?)

DRAW SOMETHING YOU NOTICED

ONE WORD TO DESCRIBE HOW NATURE MADE ME FEEL

Mindful Listening Exercise

This exercise trains your ears to notice sounds you usually ignore. You can do it indoors or outdoors. All you need is 3 minutes and a quiet spot.

1. Sit comfortably and close your eyes (or look at the floor).
2. Set a timer for **3 minutes**.
3. Listen carefully to every sound around you. Try to hear sounds that are close and sounds that are far away.
4. When the timer goes off, open your eyes and write down every sound you heard below.

SOUNDS I HEARD

Closest sound I heard:

Farthest sound I heard:

Most surprising sound:

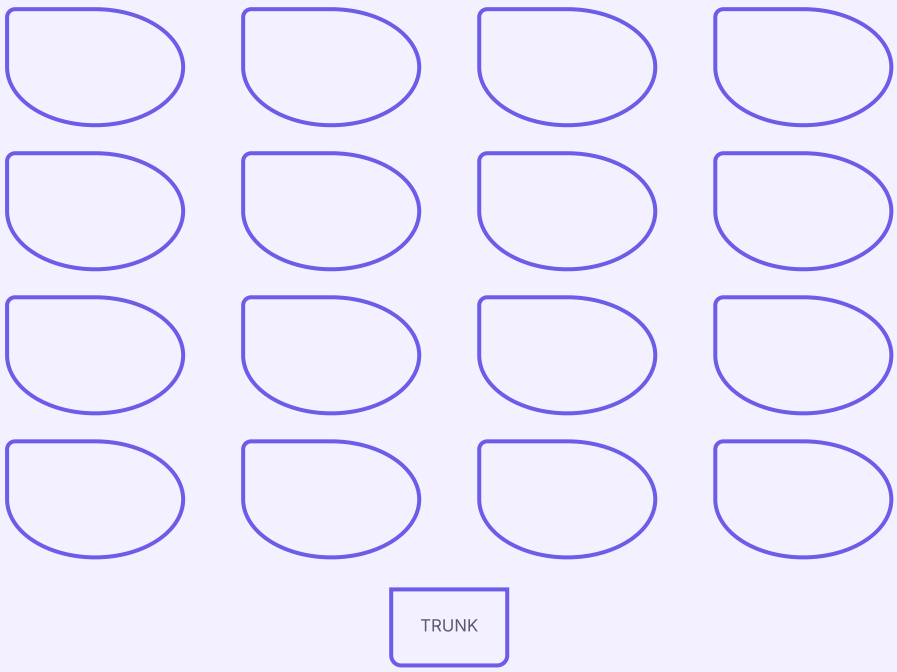
Quietest sound I noticed:

> **Level Up**
>
> Try this exercise in different places — your bedroom, the kitchen, a park, or in the car. How many sounds can you hear? Can you beat your own record?

Gratitude Tree

Write one thing you are grateful for inside each leaf. Fill the tree over days or weeks. Watch your gratitude grow! You can also color each leaf after you fill it in.

My Gratitude Tree



Ideas for Your Leaves

Stuck? Think about: people you love, your favorite food, something that made you laugh, a skill you have, a place you enjoy, a memory that makes you smile, something in nature, a toy or book you love, something your body lets you do, or a kind thing someone did for you.

Kindness Challenge Cards

Cut these out, fold them, and place them in a jar. Pick one each day and try to complete the challenge before bedtime. Kindness makes your brain release chemicals that help you feel happy and calm!

✂ ----------

Give someone in your family a surprise compliment. Tell them exactly what you like about them.

Draw a picture or write a short note for a friend and give it to them.

Help with a chore without being asked. Notice how it feels to help.

Smile at 5 different people today. Count them!

Let someone else go first — in line, choosing a game, or picking a seat.

Say “thank you” to someone who helps you, and explain why you appreciate it.

Include someone who is alone. Ask them to play or sit with you.

Make someone laugh. Tell a joke, make a silly face, or do something fun together.

✂ ----------

MY KINDNESS REFLECTION

After completing a challenge, write what you did and how it made you feel:

4

Bedtime Wind-Down

Gentle exercises to quiet your mind, release the day, and drift off to sleep.

Bedtime Body Scan

Lie in bed with the lights low. A grown-up can read this to you, or you can read it yourself slowly. After each instruction, pause and breathe twice before moving on.

- [ ] Close your eyes. Take three slow, deep breaths. Feel your body sinking into the bed.
- [ ] Bring your attention to your **feet**. Wiggle your toes, then let them relax completely. Imagine they are warm and heavy.
- [ ] Move your attention up to your **legs**. Let all the tightness melt away. Your legs are sinking gently into the mattress.
- [ ] Now notice your **belly**. Feel it rise and fall with each breath. Let your tummy be soft and relaxed.
- [ ] Bring your attention to your **hands**. Open your fingers wide, then let them curl gently. Your hands are warm and peaceful.
- [ ] Feel your **arms** getting heavier and heavier, like they are made of warm sand.
- [ ] Relax your **shoulders**. Let them drop away from your ears. Let go of any tension you were holding.
- [ ] Soften your **face**. Unclench your jaw. Let your tongue rest on the bottom of your mouth. Smooth out your forehead.
- [ ] Relax the very **top of your head**. Imagine a warm, golden light spreading from the top of your head all the way down to your toes.
- [ ] Now your whole body is relaxed. With each breath, you sink a little deeper. You are safe. You are calm. You are ready to sleep.

> **Tip for Grown-Ups**
>
> Read this in a slow, soft voice. Pause for two breaths between each instruction. If your child falls asleep before you finish, that means it is working!

Bedtime Gratitude Journal

Before you close your eyes each night, fill in one row. Thinking about good things before sleep helps your brain process positive memories while you rest.

DAY	TODAY I'M GRATEFUL FOR...	THE BEST PART OF TODAY WAS...
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

SOMETHING I AM LOOKING FORWARD TO TOMORROW

> **No Screens Rule**
>
> For the best sleep, put away all screens (tablets, phones, TV) at least 30 minutes before bed. Use that time for this journal, the body scan, or the visualization on the next pages instead.

Worry Box

Worries can keep you awake at night. This page helps you take the worries out of your head and put them somewhere safe. Write or draw your worries in the box. Then read the “Let It Go” section and choose a way to release them.

My Worries Tonight:

Let It Go — Choose One

- [ ] **Breathe it out:** Take a deep breath in, and as you breathe out, imagine the worry floating away like a cloud.
- [ ] **Shrink it:** Close your eyes and picture the worry getting smaller and smaller until it is the size of a grain of sand.
- [ ] **Lock it up:** Imagine putting each worry into a strong box with a lock. You can come back to it tomorrow if you need to, but for tonight, it is locked away safe.
- [ ] **Give it to the stars:** Imagine sending each worry up to a star in the sky. The star holds it for you while you sleep.
- [ ] **Talk about it:** Tell a grown-up about your worry. Sometimes saying it out loud makes it feel much smaller.

AFTER LETTING GO, I FEEL...

Peaceful Visualization

A visualization is like a movie you play in your mind. This guide takes you to a calm, safe place. Lie down, close your eyes, and have someone read this to you — or read it yourself and then close your eyes to imagine it.

1. **Get comfortable.** Close your eyes. Take three deep belly breaths. With each breath out, let your body relax a little more.
2. **Imagine a path.** You are standing on a soft, grassy path. The grass is cool under your bare feet. The sun is warm on your face, and a gentle breeze moves through the air.
3. **Follow the path.** You walk slowly along the path. On each side, there are colorful wildflowers — purple, yellow, orange, and pink. You can smell their sweet scent.
4. **Find the meadow.** The path leads to a beautiful, quiet meadow next to a calm, clear stream. You can hear the water flowing gently over smooth stones.
5. **Sit down.** You sit on the softest patch of grass. You notice butterflies dancing in the air. Birds sing a quiet song in the trees above you.
6. **Feel the peace.** This place is yours. Nobody is in a hurry here. There is nothing you need to do, nowhere you need to be. You are perfectly safe and perfectly calm.
7. **Breathe with the stream.** Listen to the water. Breathe in as the water flows toward you. Breathe out as it flows away. In and out. In and out.
8. **Drift off.** You lie back on the warm grass. The sky above is a deep, beautiful blue. You feel so relaxed, so peaceful. With every breath, you float a little closer to sleep...

Make It Your Own

What does *your* perfect peaceful place look like? Draw or describe it below. You can visit it anytime you close your eyes.

30-Day Mindfulness Challenge

Complete one challenge every day for 30 days. Check off each one as you finish it. By the end, you will have built a mindfulness habit that can last a lifetime!

1 Take 5 belly breaths	**2** Name 3 things you are grateful for	**3** Do the 5-4-3-2-1 senses exercise	**4** Eat one snack mindfully	**5** Say 3 affirmations out loud
6 Listen quietly for 2 minutes and count sounds	**7** Do a full body scan before bed	**8** Give someone a genuine compliment	**9** Try the breathing square 3 times	**10** Write about the best part of your day
11 Spend 5 minutes outside noticing nature	**12** Help someone without being asked	**13** Color a page slowly and mindfully	**14** Do progressive muscle relaxation	**15** Walk barefoot on grass for 3 minutes
16 Put a worry in the worry box	**17** Smile at 5 people today	**18** Drink a glass of water slowly and notice each sip	**19** Tell someone why you appreciate them	**20** Stretch your whole body for 3 minutes
21 Add a leaf to your gratitude tree	**22** Try the peaceful visualization at bedtime	**23** Draw how you feel today using only colors and shapes	**24** Take 10 breaths and count each one	**25** Let someone else choose first today
26 Sit quietly for 1 minute and think about nothing	**27** Write a kind note to yourself	**28** Notice 3 beautiful things around you	**29** Do your favorite exercise from this book	**30** Celebrate! Write what mindfulness taught you

AFTER 30 DAYS — WHAT I LEARNED ABOUT MINDFULNESS

Next Step

You now have everything you need to practice mindfulness every single day. Remember: there is no perfect way to do it. Some days will be easier than others, and that is completely normal.

Start small — even one minute of belly breathing or one line in your gratitude journal makes a difference. Over time, these small moments of calm add up to a bigger, stronger, more peaceful you.

Keep this book in a place where you can see it every day. When things feel hard, come back to these pages. Your calm, focused mind is always here waiting for you.

You are doing an amazing job. Keep going!